

Steve Landon

Claims Leader · CPCU · Data-Driven · Technology-Forward
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SUMMARY

Claims leader with 18 years at Farmers Insurance specializing in large loss, catastrophic injury, and complex litigation. Proven track record of transforming team performance, deploying data-driven operational strategies, and building high-performing adjuster talent pipelines at scale.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Territory Manager, Complex Claims & Large Loss

January 2024 – Present

Farmers Insurance — East Zone

Transformed team quality and operational performance across multi-state complex claims portfolio

- Leads a team of General Adjusters handling large loss, catastrophic injury, and complex coverage claims across New York, Illinois, and Wisconsin
- Reduced team's Does Not Meet file rate by 62% year-over-year through targeted coaching and technical development upon taking over the team
- Achieved team quality metric of 91.4% (Exceeds threshold) in 2025; reserve accuracy ranks consistently among the highest in Complex Claims
- Employee Experience survey scores rank above zone, company, division, and industry averages
- Designed and led a zone-wide mentorship program providing biweekly technical roundtables for Tier 3 and Tier 4 adjusters across the East Zone
- Co-designed business logic for a Power BI diagnostic tool now deployed throughout Complex Claims; presented use cases to directors and leads an ongoing cross-zone focus group to identify additional use cases and streamline functionality
- Built analytics tools, SharePoint portals, and operational reporting infrastructure and provided support for other zones creating similar tools
- Redesigned a complex Excel Spreadsheet used for tracking assignments to personal auto complex teams nationwide
- Sought out by peer Territory Managers for guidance on team development and quality improvement strategies
- Delivers monthly feedback to the East Zone management team in targeted areas related to metrics

General Adjuster → Senior General Adjuster → Special General Adjuster January 2016 – January 2024

Farmers Insurance — East Zone NLC / Complex Claims

- Handled large loss, catastrophic injury, and complex coverage litigation claims across the NLC/Complex Claims department
- Medicare Subject Matter Expert — presented on Medicare lien handling at invitation of Central Zone NLC office
- Guidewire Claims Center (GWCC) Subject Matter Expert — assisted in rolling out GWCC to East Zone NLC team
- Selected as Super User for Guidewire Claims Center system migration (2018-2019) — served as primary problem-solving resource during transition
- Mentored Tier 3 adjusters; led bi-weekly technical roundtables with Illinois Field Office
- Created training workshops covering CPL claims, umbrella policies, coverage analysis, and conditional demands
- Contributed to Tier 3 Technical Development Program and revamped Tier 3 Bench Strength Mentorship Program — presented to senior executives
- Achieved 140% closings (2023)

Senior Liability Claims Representative → Special Liability Claims Representative

April 2012 –

January 2016

Farmers Insurance — Illinois Claims Office

- Managed independent inventory of attorney-represented and litigated liability claims
- Designed an Excel-based documentation tool to standardize and improve claim file narratives — still in active use today
- Taught internal classes on intracompany arbitration handling and Medicare lien handling
- Selected as primary trainer for HEART claims system migration — trained approximately 50 staff members across multiple offices including travel to Springfield; conducted follow-up training session
- Promoted mid-tenure from Senior to Special Liability Claims Representative

Assignment Coordinator (XM)

Approximately 2010 – April 2012

Farmers Insurance — Illinois Claims Office

- Managed claim assignment and workflow for Represented Soft Tissue team
- Redesigned tracking systems and assignment structure — supervisor later noted role was "redefined" under his tenure

Liability Claims Representative / RST Claims Representative August 2008 – Approximately 2010

Farmers Insurance — Illinois Claims Office

- Handled unrepresented soft tissue liability claims and subsequently attorney-represented soft tissue claims
- Promoted from Claims Representative to Assignment Coordinator role within approximately 18 months

Earlier Experience

2001 – 2008

Teacher's Assistant, Glenbard South High School (2008) · Shift Leader → Store Manager track, Blockbuster Video (2001–2007)

EDUCATION & DESIGNATIONS

- Master of Business Administration (In Progress — Anticipated Summer 2027) — University of Texas Permian Basin (AACSB Accredited)
- Bachelor of Science, History Education — Cum Laude — Illinois State University (Lawrence McBride Award for Outstanding Student Teaching; Award for Outstanding Portfolio)
- CPCU — Chartered Property Casualty Underwriter, The Institutes · Member, CPCU Society
- SCLA Gold — Senior Claim Law Associate, American Educational Institute · Member, SCLA Society
- AIC-M — Associate in Claims, Management
- AINS — Associate in Insurance
- Licensed in all states requiring licensure

CORE COMPETENCIES

Leadership & Strategy

Team Leadership & Development · Coaching & Performance Management · Claims Strategy · Culture & Engagement · Process Improvement

Technical Claims Expertise

Large Loss & Catastrophic Injury Claims · Complex Coverage & Litigation · Litigation Management · Coverage Analysis

Data & Business Insight

Data Analytics & Operational Reporting · Performance Metrics & Quality Management · Power BI · Data-Driven Decision Making · SharePoint · AI-Assisted Workflows

Training & Organizational Impact

Training Program Development · Mentorship & Talent Pipeline Development · Technical Instruction · Writing & Executive Communication